Afterglow

Stage one. Gold of last light.

STAGE 1 · GOLD OF LAST LIGHT

HEX	#D8B260
OKLCH	0.781 0.110 84.9
ON VOID	**9.97:1**
TEXT ON IT	**1.70:1**
ROLE	Text, marks and rules on the void

The fall reaches this value at 0.0 per cent of the document.

One fragrance told in four stages, from the gold of last light to deep violet. You do not see the bottle until the end.

The light only ever deepens,
never brightens.

This page is obeying that rule. The ground beneath this page is darker than the ground you started on, and it will not return.

Stage two. After gold.

STAGE 2 · AFTER GOLD

HEX	#BC6F4C
OKLCH	0.619 0.110 44.7
ON VOID	**5.26:1**
TEXT ON IT	**3.23:1**
ROLE	Large text or fills. Borderline as text

The fall reaches this value at 33.3 per cent of the document.

Below this turn the ground carries body copy. Above it nothing does: primary text reads 1.70:1 on the gold end and fails even the large-text floor, so everything so far is set in the void and sized as display.

07

The surface map

Void is the page. #141414 is recessed, #2B2B2B is raised, and the hairline is the border token at rgba(192,192,192,0.22). Shadow is absent from this list on purpose: on a void ground, elevation reads through the surface steps, because a shadow has nothing to fall on.

Those three are not on the ramp, so they cannot be read off the page the way a stage can. They are specified in the readings below, which is the void and steps through them, so the family is demonstrated by the thing reporting it.

CROSSOVER

GROUND	#A2544E
OKLCH L	0.538
TEXT ON IT	**4.55:1**

The fall reaches this value at 50.0 per cent of the document.

GROUND

HEX	#080808
OKLCH L	0.134
TEXT ON IT	**17.00:1**
MUTED ON IT	**11.01:1**
USE	Page ground. Required by the deepening-light rule, not borrowed

SURFACE, RECESSED

HEX	#141414
OKLCH L	0.191
TEXT ON IT	**15.63:1**
MUTED ON IT	**10.13:1**
USE	Recessed panels

SURFACE, RAISED

HEX	#2B2B2B
OKLCH L	0.289
TEXT ON IT	**12.02:1**
MUTED ON IT	**7.78:1**
USE	Cards and raised panels

08

Stage roles

A ramp whose lightness falls monotonically cannot carry text at both ends. The later stages land near 2:1 and 1.4:1 on the void, which is not a flaw in the rule, it is what the rule implies. The failing numbers are printed because they are the reason for the restriction.

Gold of last light

Light enough to set as text, a mark or a rule on the void.

On void **9.97:1** · clears 3:1 · text on it **1.70:1**

After gold

Large text or fills. Borderline as running text and not to be used as it.

On void **5.26:1** · clears 3:1 · text on it **3.23:1**

Rose

Fills, grounds and large shapes. Never a letterform.

On void **2.66:1** · fails 3:1 · text on it **6.40:1**

Deep violet

Fills, grounds and large shapes. Never a letterform.

On void **1.41:1** · fails 3:1 · text on it **12.01:1**

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Type

Display is Instrument Serif, body is Space Grotesk. Both are in Shopify's font library, so neither ships as a webfont; the cost is one added font picker, since the theme carries exactly one.

The scale is a ratio, not a list. Base 16 px, ratio 1.25, every step derived. This section is set in those faces at those sizes, so it is a specimen of itself.

XS	Deepening	12.8 px · 0.8 rem
BASE	Deepening	16 px · 1 rem
MD	Deepening	20 px · 1.25 rem
LG	Deepening	25 px · 1.562 rem
XL	Deepening	31.25 px · 1.953 rem
2XL	Deepening	39.06 px · 2.441 rem

STAGE 3 · ROSE

HEX	#893A50
OKLCH	0.461 0.110 5.0
ON VOID	**2.66:1**
TEXT ON IT	**6.40:1**
ROLE	Ground, never a letterform

The fall reaches this value at 66.7 per cent of the document.

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Spacing, radius, shadow, motion

Spacing is an 8 px base and whole multiples of it: 4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64. Eight divides the 16 px type base, so space and text sit on one grid rather than two that nearly agree.

Radius is 0. Shadow is none. Motion runs at 450 ms on cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0.2, 1), a curve that ends at its destination and never passes it, which is what deepening rather than snapping means in a timing function.

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Usage

The brand’s central idea is a sentence about mood that nobody can act on: the light only ever deepens. The usable form is an interaction rule.

> No state change brightens. Hover, focus and active deepen or shift hue, and never lighten. Nothing fades up to a brighter value. That is checkable in a diff, which is the main reason this document is worth having.

Stages three and four are never letterforms. Stage two is not running text. Those are not preferences; the measured ratios on page 08 are the reason.

Where the rules stop. Cart and checkout are plain and fast, and the atmosphere stops there on purpose, exactly as the voice does. The deepening discipline serves browsing and gets out of the way where clarity beats mood. Applied to a payment form it would make the form worse.

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Voice

Unhurried and physical. It names heat, light, breath and skin. It describes a sequence, because the product is a sequence. Certain without pushing: the brand does not argue for itself, and assumes you will understand it if you are shown it in the right order.

The full voice, the word lists and the tone by context live in voice-tone.md, which this document does not duplicate.

STAGE 4 · DEEP VIOLET

HEX	#341D5E
OKLCH	0.301 0.110 295.2
ON VOID	**1.41:1**
TEXT ON IT	**12.01:1**
ROLE	Ground, never a letterform

The fall reaches this value at 100.0 per cent of the document.